

AI for Analytical Storytelling

How to leverage AI to uncover insights, visualize data, and tell better stories.

Eoin McMillan

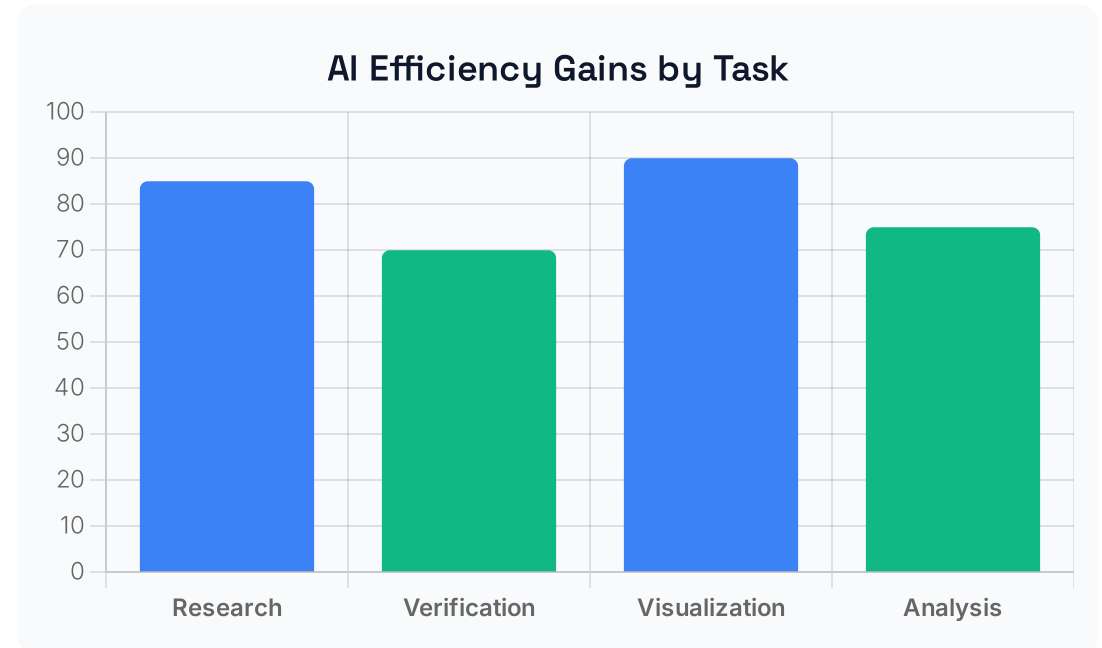
Founder & CEO, Sourcetable.com

SPECIAL SESSION FOR CUNY JOURNALISM STUDENTS



| The New Era of Data Journalism

- ✓ Modern reporting requires **evidence-based narratives** beyond traditional interviews.
- ✓ Journalists with data skills have the best chance of uncovering **headline insights**.
- ✓ AI acts as a **superpowered research assistant**, not a replacement for the journalist.
- ✓ Transition from "what happened" to "**why it happened**" using analytical tools.



Source: Industry Trends in Digital Journalism, 2026

Analytical Reporting with AI



Pattern Recognition

Instantly identify trends and recurring themes across years of historical data.



Dataset Comparison

Compare disparate datasets (e.g., city budgets vs. crime rates) in seconds.



Spotting Outliers

Automatically flag anomalies that indicate a potential scoop or investigation.



AI turns a wall of numbers into a roadmap for your story.

Quantitative Analysis & Verifiable Outputs

No-Code Data Science

- > **Quantitative Rigor:** Move beyond anecdotes to statistically significant findings.
- > **Natural Language:** Perform complex tasks like regressions and correlations without writing code.
- > **Democratization:** Advanced analytics is now accessible to every reporter, not just the data desk.

Accuracy & Verification

- ✓ **AI generates the logic**
- ✓ **Journalist remains the editor**
- ✓ **Verifiable formula outputs**
- ✓ **Cross-check manual math**

"AI helps you find the truth; you are responsible for proving it."

Automate the "Grunt Work" of Research



Web Scraping

Turn messy websites and unstructured online data into clean, structured tables for instant analysis.



Tabular Research

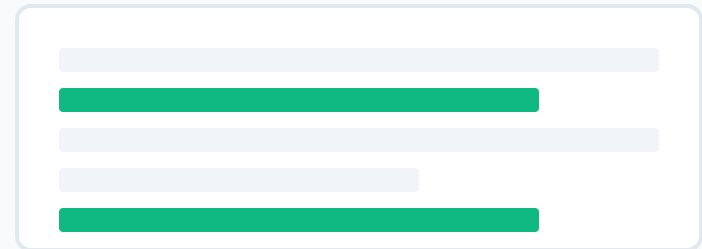
Aggregate data from multiple disparate sources into a single, verifiable source of truth.



Efficiency at Scale

Spend less time collecting data and more time investigating.
Handle thousands of rows as easily as a dozen.

STRUCTURED OUTPUT



10x

FASTER DATA COLLECTION

Data Prep: The Foundation of Good Stories

Clean data is the prerequisite for honest reporting.



Cleaning

Automatically fix **formatting errors**, remove duplicates, and handle missing values to ensure dataset integrity.



Merging

Combine datasets from **disparate sources** (CSVs, SQL databases, and PDFs) into a single unified view.



Structuring

Transform messy, unstructured text into **usable categories** and columns for systematic analysis.



Parsing

Extract specific, high-value information from **large-scale documents** and unstructured data dumps.

Spend less time fighting with spreadsheets and more time investigating the story.

Advanced Analysis Without Code



Direct Database Access

Connect to SQL databases (Postgres, MySQL) using natural language—no SQL required.



Large File Analysis

Analyze massive CSVs and datasets that would crash traditional spreadsheet software.



Data Democratization

Advanced analytics is now accessible to every reporter, not just the specialized "data desk."

NATURAL LANGUAGE QUERY

"Which neighborhood saw the highest rent increase in the last 12 months?"

AI ANALYSIS RESULT

Analysis complete.

Top Result: Bushwick, Brooklyn

Increase: +14.2% YoY

Data Source: NYC Housing Registry (2.4M rows)

Query massive datasets as easily as asking a question.

Visualizing the Narrative

AI Chart Generation

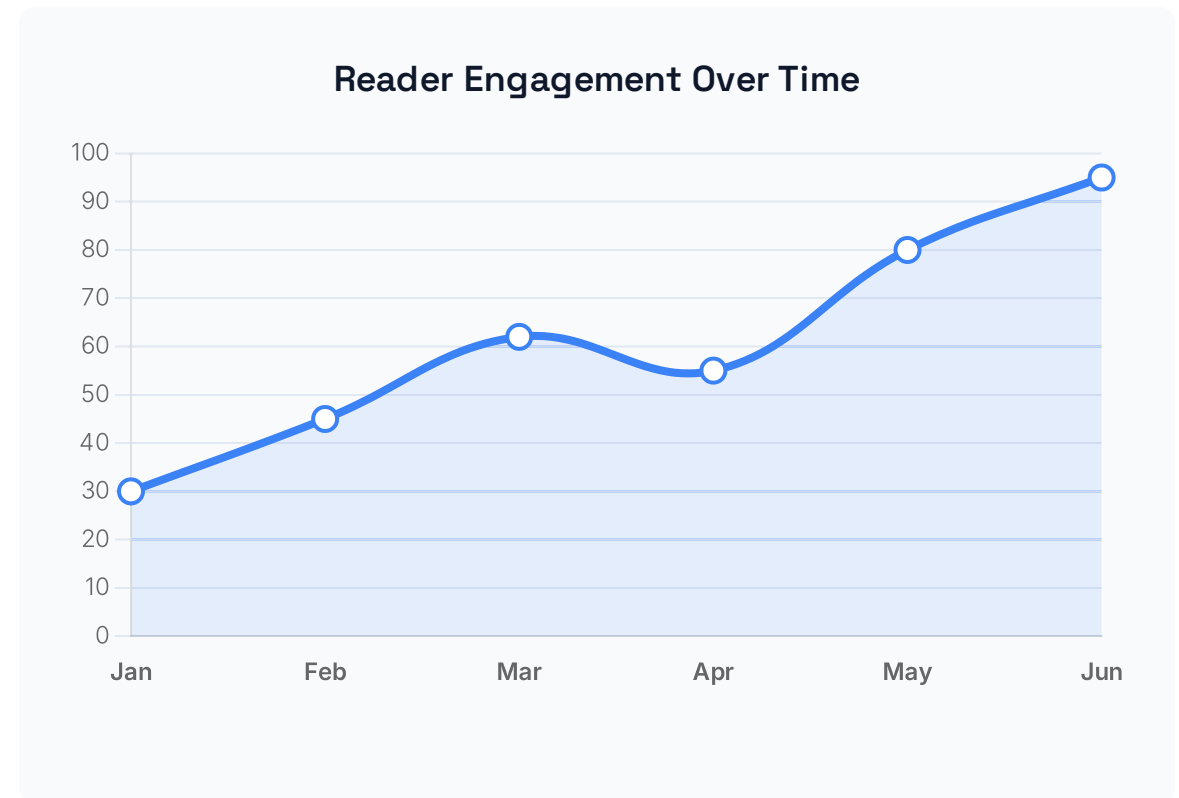
Describe the visualization you want in plain English, and AI builds the interactive graphic instantly.

Publishing Ready

Seamlessly move from deep analysis to a publishing-ready widget for your digital platform.

Clarity & Impact

Use AI to choose the most effective chart type to communicate your specific story to the audience.



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01

Sign Up

Go to **sourcetable.com** and use your **cuny.edu** email to create a free account.

02

Analyze a Dataset

Upload a CSV or connect a data source. Try asking the AI to "find the top 3 trends" in your data.

03

Visualize

Generate an interactive chart and prepare it for your next storytelling project.

sourcetable.com/llms.txt

The Future of Journalism is Analytical

-  **Empowerment:** AI is a tool for empowerment, not replacement. It scales your curiosity.
-  **Start Small:** Pick one dataset, ask one question, and let the data guide your story.
-  **Accessibility:** Advanced analytics is now open to every reporter with a story to tell.

Questions?

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The best stories are hidden in the data—go find them.